

The AI stack, top to bottom

One request, and every layer it passes through.

COMPONENT

PROCESS

TECHNIQUE

CONTROL

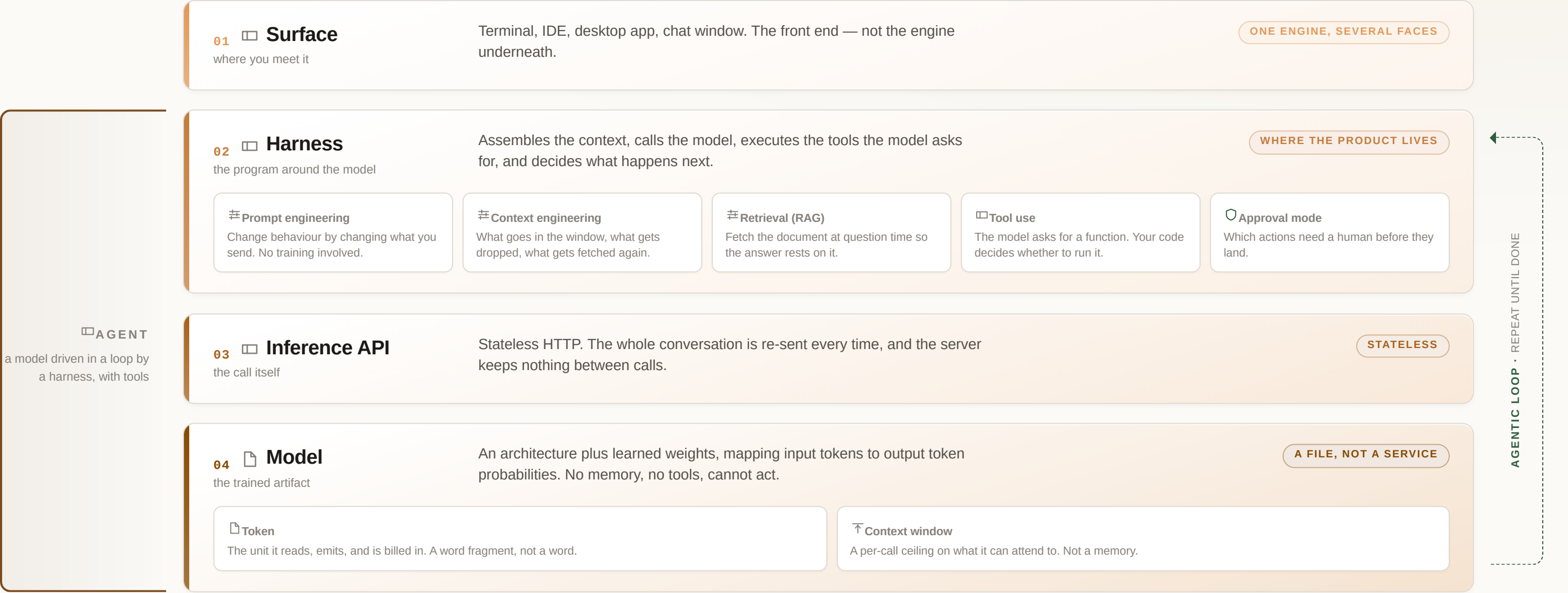
FAILURE

MEASURE

CEILING

ARTIFACT

WHO



WHO IS INVOLVED

- WHO

Model provider

— Trains it, owns the weights, sets the licence.
- WHO

Model host

— Runs someone else’s model and sells access.

WHAT GOES WRONG

- FAILURE

Hallucination

— Confident, plausible, wrong — and indistinguishable from correct output, because truth is not a quantity the model computes.

HOW YOU KNOW

- MEASURE

Evaluation

— A repeatable test. The only thing that turns “it seems better” into a claim someone else can check.

Almost everything people attribute to “the AI” — that it remembers, searches, runs code, asks permission — belongs to the harness, not the model.